

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7)

Chapter 6: The Age of Reorganisation

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	6 — The Age of Reorganisation
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Watch the chapter's classic traps: the Maurya Empire broke up from WITHIN (it was not destroyed by foreign invaders); the foreign rulers were largely absorbed into Indian culture rather than erasing it; a matrimonial alliance was an act of diplomacy, not just a wedding; queens could hold real power; and never swap the Gandhara (Greco-Buddhist) and Mathura (indigenous, red-sandstone) schools of art. Keep the dates and the order of dynasties straight. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. Historians call the period from roughly the 2nd century BCE to the 3rd century CE the 'Age of Reorganisation' chiefly because:

- (A) one new empire reorganised the whole subcontinent under a single ruler
- (B) old regions were repeatedly reshaped into many new, competing kingdoms
- (C) the Mauryan administration was reorganised into larger provinces
- (D) foreign rulers reorganised India into a single Silk-Route state

2. What actually triggered the breakup of the Maurya Empire?

- (A) an Indo-Greek army stormed and burned the Mauryan capital
- (B) the Kushanas under Kanishka annexed it
- (C) a Satavahana invasion from the Deccan toppled it
- (D) its last emperor was assassinated by his own commander-in-chief

3. The general who killed the last Maurya emperor around 185 BCE and began a new dynasty was:

- (A) Kharavela of Kalinga
- (B) Pushyamitra Shunga
- (C) Kanishka the Kushana
- (D) Gautamiputra Satakarni

4. 'The invaders came only after the Mauryas fell.' This ordering of events best supports the conclusion that:

- (A) the internal breakup came first and left the northwest weak, which then let invaders in
- (B) the invaders' attacks were the cause of the Mauryan collapse
- (C) the Mauryas and the invaders ruled India at the same time
- (D) the northwest had never belonged to the Mauryas

5. Which single statement best captures the chapter's overall picture of the Age of Reorganisation?

- (A) endless warfare made it a cultural dark age with no achievements
- (B) intense political competition and rich cultural blending went hand in hand
- (C) it was a peaceful age with no wars, only trade
- (D) every kingdom in it was ruled by foreign invaders

6. Apart from open warfare, the chief means by which kingdoms of this age won and secured territory was:

- (A) matrimonial alliances between royal families
- (B) holding elections among the nobles
- (C) sending out Buddhist missionaries
- (D) abolishing every rival kingdom's identity

7. A king gives his daughter in marriage to a neighbouring prince to end a long rivalry and link their lands. The chapter would read this mainly as:

- (A) an act of diplomacy, politics conducted through marriage
- (B) a purely private family celebration with no wider meaning
- (C) a religious sacrifice to win the gods' favour
- (D) a method of collecting annual tribute

8. Why would a ruler of this age perform the ashvamedha (horse-sacrifice) yajna?

- (A) to proclaim himself a supreme king, claiming every land his freed horse crossed unchallenged
- (B) to select the next emperor by drawing lots
- (C) to formalise a marriage alliance with another dynasty
- (D) to mark the first day of a new calendar era

9. That a widowed Satavahana queen is recorded as performing the ashvamedha yajna is used by the chapter to show that:

- (A) only men ever wielded power in these kingdoms
- (B) the ritual had nothing to do with claiming kingship
- (C) the Satavahanas had given up Vedic rituals entirely
- (D) royal women could exercise real political and ritual authority

10. The Shunga dynasty is best remembered in the chapter for:

- (A) building a sea-trading empire that reached Rome
- (B) reviving Vedic rituals and adorning the Bharhut Stupa

- (C) controlling the Silk Route across Central Asia
- (D) issuing the Shaka Samvat calendar

11. The Shungas revived Vedic ritual, yet the Bharhut Stupa they adorned is a Buddhist monument. This pairing best illustrates that:

- (A) the Shungas had secretly become Buddhist rulers
- (B) supporting one tradition did not prevent the making of fine art for another in this age
- (C) the Bharhut Stupa was really a Vedic temple
- (D) Buddhism had completely vanished by Shunga times

12. In this chapter, a 'stupa' is:

- (A) an anthology of Tamil love-and-heroism poems
- (B) a dome-shaped Buddhist monument, often with carved railings and reliefs
- (C) a low dam built across a river to feed canals
- (D) a free-standing Greek-style victory pillar

13. The Shungas held power mainly in:

- (A) the far south, in the Tamil country
- (B) the Deccan plateau
- (C) the Central Asian steppe
- (D) north and central India

14. The Satavahanas built their power in which region?

- (A) the Tamil far south
- (B) north and central India
- (C) the northwest frontier
- (D) the Deccan plateau

15. Satavahana coins that show ships are taken as direct evidence that the dynasty:

- (A) worshipped the sea as a god
- (B) had lost all its land territory
- (C) carried on a flourishing sea trade
- (D) built warships to fight the Kushanas

16. A Satavahana king bears the name 'Gautamiputra'. What does this naming custom tell us?

- (A) kings were named after the god they worshipped
- (B) 'Gautami' was the dynasty's founding city
- (C) the name marks him out as a Buddhist monk
- (D) kings could be named after their mothers, signalling the standing of royal women

17. Royal women like Gautami Balashri are known to us mainly because they:

- (A) donated land and had their gifts recorded in inscriptions
- (B) led Satavahana armies into battle against Rome
- (C) composed the Sangam poems of the Tamil south
- (D) designed the Gandhara style of sculpture

18. Mother-names, land-donating queens and a queen's ashvamedha together overturn which common belief about these kingdoms?

- (A) that the Satavahanas lived in the Deccan
- (B) that coins can serve as historical evidence
- (C) that the age saw frequent warfare
- (D) that queens were merely decorative and only kings ever held power

19. The Satavahanas' trade reaching as far as Rome is best explained by their:

- (A) sharing a land border with the Roman Empire
- (B) membership of the Roman Empire as a province
- (C) control of Deccan ports and sea routes to the west
- (D) control of the overland Silk Route through China

20. King Kharavela, famous in this chapter, ruled the kingdom of:

- (A) the Deccan, as a Satavahana ruler
- (B) Gandhara, as a Kushana ruler
- (C) the Tamil south, as a Chera ruler
- (D) Kalinga, as a Chedi ruler

21. Kharavela is described as a 'monk-king' because he:

- (A) gave up his throne to become a wandering monk
- (B) was a Buddhist bhikkhu who never actually ruled
- (C) was a devout follower of Jainism while still ruling as king
- (D) founded a brand-new monastic religion of his own

22. Most of what we know about Kharavela comes from the Hathigumpha inscription. This illustrates the historian's reliance on:

- (A) Sangam poetry written about him in Tamil
- (B) Roman trade records that name him
- (C) inscriptions, writing carved into lasting material, as historical sources
- (D) coins struck with his portrait

23. An 'inscription', as the chapter uses the term, is:

- (A) a coin stamped with a king's face
- (B) a poem memorised and recited aloud
- (C) a painting on a cave wall
- (D) writing carved into stone or metal, often recording a ruler's deeds or gifts

24. The 'three crowned kingdoms' of the southern Tamil country were the:

- (A) Shungas, Satavahanas and Chedis
- (B) Indo-Greeks, Shakas and Kushanas
- (C) Cholas, Cheras and Pandyas
- (D) Mauryas, Nandas and Guptas

25. The 'Sangam Age' takes its name from:

- (A) a series of great battles among southern kings
- (B) anthologies of early Tamil poetry composed in the south
- (C) an assembly that elected the Chola king
- (D) a Buddhist council held in the Deccan

26. Sangam poems mostly sing of:

- (A) love, heroism and generosity
- (B) the rules of Vedic sacrifice
- (C) the lives of the Kushana emperors
- (D) the trade laws of the Silk Route

27. Finding Roman gold coins in the Tamil south is best explained by the fact that the southern kingdoms:

- (A) were conquered and taxed by Rome
- (B) minted their own coins in Roman workshops
- (C) traded by sea with the Roman world (D) sent their kings to be crowned in Rome

28. Which pairing of region and power is correct for this age?

- (A) the Deccan, the Cholas (B) Kalinga, the Cheras
- (C) the Tamil far south, the Pandyas (D) the northwest, the Pandyas

29. The Grand Anicut (Kallanai) built by the Cholas was:

- (A) a stupa raised over relics of the Buddha (B) a Greek-style victory pillar
- (C) a coastal fort built to keep out Roman ships
- (D) an ancient dam across the Kaveri to spread its water over the delta

30. An 'anicut', as the word's Tamil roots show, is:

- (A) a low dam built to raise river water and divert it into canals
- (B) a royal marriage treaty between dynasties (C) a dome-shaped Buddhist monument
- (D) a counted calendar era

31. Why did the Grand Anicut matter so much to Chola prosperity?

- (A) it blocked Roman ships from entering Chola ports
- (B) it served as the dynasty's main fortress
- (C) it watered the Kaveri delta, turning it into a rich rice-growing region that fed the kingdom
- (D) it marked the boundary with the Pandya kingdom

32. The Cheras and Pandyas of the south grew wealthy chiefly through:

- (A) control of the overland Silk Route
- (B) tribute paid to them by the Kushana empire
- (C) gold mines in the Central Asian steppe (D) sea-trade, including trade with Rome

33. Roman writers' knowledge of pepper and other goods from the Tamil coast is best taken as evidence of:

- (A) a Roman military conquest of south India
- (B) active sea trade linking south India and the Mediterranean
- (C) Roman settlers founding the southern kingdoms
- (D) the Tamil kings ruling parts of Italy

34. Which best contrasts how the Satavahanas and the Tamil kingdoms each reached Rome?

- (A) the Satavahanas by land, the Tamils by sea
- (B) both reached Rome by sea trade rather than by land

- 35.** The Indo-Greeks who entered the northwest were descended from:
- (A) the satraps (governors) left behind by Alexander
 - (B) the Shunga kings of central India
 - (C) the Chedi rulers of Kalinga
 - (D) the Kushana emperors of Central Asia
- 36.** The Heliodorus pillar, set up by a Greek ambassador who honoured an Indian god, is used to show that the Indo-Greeks:
- (A) forced Greek gods on every Indian subject
 - (B) refused all contact with Indian religion
 - (C) blended Greek and Indian culture, even adopting Indian beliefs
 - (D) destroyed Indian temples wherever they ruled
- 37.** Indo-Greek coins are especially valuable to historians because they:
- (A) were never actually used for trade
 - (B) were all minted in the city of Rome
 - (C) supply most of what we know about these rulers, including their names and portraits
 - (D) recorded the Sangam poems in Greek
- 38.** The Indo-Greeks managing to enter India is itself a consequence of:
- (A) an invitation from the Chola kings
 - (B) the building of the Silk Route by the Kushanas
 - (C) the weakening of the northwest frontier after the Mauryan breakup
 - (D) the start of the Shaka Samvat calendar
- 39.** Which statement about the foreign rulers in India is most accurate?
- (A) they were largely absorbed into Indian culture, which remained dominant
 - (B) they wiped out Indian culture and replaced it with their own
 - (C) they kept entirely apart, mixing nothing
 - (D) they ruled the whole subcontinent as one empire
- 40.** The Shakas are also known as the:
- (A) Indo-Greeks
 - (B) Indo-Scythians
 - (C) Indo-Romans
 - (D) Indo-Cholas
- 41.** Which lasting timekeeping system is associated with the Shaka period?
- (A) the Shaka Samvat calendar
 - (B) the Roman Julian calendar
 - (C) the Sangam poetry cycle
 - (D) the ashvamedha festival calendar
- 42.** A 'samvat' is best defined as:
- (A) a low dam across a river
 - (B) a dome-shaped Buddhist shrine
 - (C) a counted era or calendar beginning from a fixed event

(D) a royal marriage alliance

43. That India still uses a national calendar based on the Shaka era shows that this age:

- (A) produced nothing that survived its own time
- (B) left lasting marks on Indian life, not just ruins
- (C) was entirely the work of Roman officials
- (D) had no contact with Indian traditions

44. The most famous Kushana ruler in the chapter is:

- (A) Kharavela
- (B) Kanishka
- (C) Pushyamitra
- (D) Gautamiputra

45. The Kushanas' wealth and importance rested largely on their control of:

- (A) the Silk Route linking China to the Mediterranean
- (B) the Grand Anicut on the Kaveri
- (C) the carved railings of the Bharhut Stupa
- (D) the Sangam poetry academies

46. The 'Silk Route' is best described as:

- (A) a sea lane running from the Deccan straight to Rome
- (B) a road built by the Cholas across the Kaveri delta
- (C) a travelling circuit followed by Tamil poets
- (D) a network of overland trade routes connecting China with the Mediterranean through Central Asia

47. What does Kanishka's coinage reveal about him?

- (A) that he rejected all religion
- (B) that he ruled the Tamil south
- (C) that he never engaged in any trade
- (D) his royal titles and the various gods he honoured

48. The Kushanas controlling the Silk Route while the Satavahanas traded by sea shows that, in this age, India:

- (A) was tied into long-distance trade by both land and sea
- (B) traded only within its own villages
- (C) was completely cut off from the outside world
- (D) depended on a single trade route for everything

49. The Gandhara school of art is best described as:

- (A) a Greco-Buddhist style giving Buddhist subjects Hellenistic forms like wavy hair and toga-like robes
- (B) an indigenous style carving figures in spotted red sandstone
- (C) a school of Tamil poetry from the south
- (D) a style of dam-and-canal engineering

50. The Mathura school of art is distinguished by:

- (A) indigenous Indian figures carved in spotted red sandstone with fuller, rounder forms
- (B) Hellenistic robes and wavy Greek hair
- (C) poems about love and heroism
- (D) ship designs stamped on coins

51. The key difference between the Gandhara and Mathura schools is that:

- (A) Gandhara was Tamil while Mathura was Greek
- (B) both were purely Greek with no Indian element
- (C) Gandhara fused Greek forms with Buddhist subjects, while Mathura was an indigenous Indian style
- (D) both were styles of Tamil poetry, not sculpture

52. Gandhara sculpture giving the Buddha Greek-style robes and wavy hair is a clear example of:

- (A) one culture completely destroying another
- (B) art produced with no foreign influence at all
- (C) cultural confluence, different traditions blending into a new shared style
- (D) a return to purely Vedic ritual

53. 'Cultural confluence', as the chapter uses it, means:

- (A) the total replacement of one culture by another
- (B) the blending of different cultures into new shared styles while a dominant local character remains
- (C) keeping every culture strictly separate
- (D) the spread of a single culture with no change at all

54. Which great works of Sanskrit literature does the chapter link to this age?

- (A) the Sangam Tamil anthologies
- (B) the Arthashastra of the Mauryan court
- (C) the Hathigumpha inscription
- (D) the Mahabharata and the Ramayana

55. The fact that foreign rulers' coins and art ended up with 'Indian themes always at the heart' supports the idea that India:

- (A) violently expelled every foreign influence
- (B) was completely Hellenised, losing its identity
- (C) stopped all artistic activity during the invasions
- (D) absorbed and transformed the newcomers rather than being erased by them

56. The chapter's claim that this was a time of 'remarkable cultural confluence' rests on examples such as:

- (A) a single uniform style imposed across all of India
- (B) the complete absence of any foreign element
- (C) Gandhara art, Kanishka's many-gods coins, and flourishing Sanskrit texts
- (D) the disappearance of India's own religions

57. Why does the chapter stress that without coins and inscriptions we would know far less about this age?

- (A) because no one living then could read or write
- (B) because the period left behind no buildings at all
- (C) because all written histories of it were translations from Rome
- (D) because so much of our evidence for its rulers, trade and religion is physical, not written chronicles

58. Which list contains ONLY items historians use as physical sources for this age?

- (A) coins, cave inscriptions and sculptures
- (B) coins, election ballots and newspapers
- (C) emails, photographs and passports
- (D) constitutions, voter rolls and tax software

59. Which sequence places these events in correct chronological order (earliest first)?

- (A) Kanishka's Kushana rule, then the Maurya breakup, then the rise of the Satavahanas
- (B) Maurya breakup, then the rise of the Satavahanas, then Kanishka's Kushana rule
- (C) the rise of the Satavahanas, then Kanishka's Kushana rule, then the Maurya breakup
- (D) Kanishka's Kushana rule, then the rise of the Satavahanas, then the Maurya breakup

60. A student writes: 'The Age of Reorganisation proves that political division and cultural creativity can occur together.' The best support from the chapter is:

- (A) the whole subcontinent was peacefully unified under one ruler
- (B) constant wars among many kingdoms coincided with new art schools, busy trade and great Sanskrit works
- (C) all art and trade stopped until a single empire returned
- (D) foreign rulers banned every form of Indian culture

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 6: The Age of Reorganisation

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	B	11	B	21	C	31	C	41	A	51	C
2	D	12	B	22	C	32	D	42	C	52	C
3	B	13	D	23	D	33	B	43	B	53	B
4	A	14	D	24	C	34	B	44	B	54	D
5	B	15	C	25	B	35	A	45	A	55	D
6	A	16	D	26	A	36	C	46	D	56	C
7	A	17	A	27	C	37	C	47	D	57	D
8	A	18	D	28	C	38	C	48	A	58	A
9	D	19	C	29	D	39	A	49	A	59	B
10	B	20	D	30	A	40	B	50	A	60	B

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (B) The name marks how the political map kept being rearranged: after the Mauryas broke up, regions were reshaped into many rival kingdoms that fought and allied for power. There was no single unifying empire in this age, and the reorganisation was of the whole map of kingdoms, not merely of Mauryan provinces.

2. (D) The empire broke from WITHIN: around 185 BCE the last Maurya ruler was assassinated by his commander-in-chief, Pushyamitra Shunga. The foreign peoples entered the northwest only later, after the breakup had weakened the frontier; they did not cause the collapse.

3. (B) Pushyamitra Shunga, the Mauryan commander-in-chief, assassinated the last emperor and founded the Shunga dynasty. Kharavela ruled Kalinga, Kanishka was a later Kushana, and Gautamiputra was a Satavahana, none of whom ended Mauryan rule.

4. (A) Because the breakup is dated before the invasions, it cannot have been caused by them; instead the collapse left the frontier undefended, and the Indo-Greeks, Shakas and Kushanas exploited that opening afterwards. Cause precedes effect here.

- 5. (B)** The chapter's big idea is that this was at once an age of fierce war-and-alliance competition AND a time of remarkable cultural confluence: new art schools, busy trade and great Sanskrit texts. War and cultural flowering happened together; one did not cancel the other.
- 6. (A)** Kings married their children into other dynasties to seal peace and join lands, a deliberate political tool that often achieved what war could not. These were monarchies, not elective states, and the alliances kept rival identities alive rather than abolishing them.
- 7. (A)** A matrimonial alliance was a tool of POLITICS, not just a wedding: it cemented friendship and merged territories between dynasties. It was diplomatic, not a private affair, not a religious rite, and not a tribute payment.
- 8. (A)** The ashvamedha was a Vedic ritual asserting supreme kingship: a horse was let loose and all the territory it wandered across unopposed was claimed by the king. It was about declaring paramount power, not elections, marriages or calendars.
- 9. (D)** A queen performing this supreme-kingship ritual shows that Satavahana royal women held genuine authority, consistent with kings taking mother-names and queens donating land and commissioning inscriptions. It contradicts the idea that women were mere royal decoration.
- 10. (B)** The Shungas of north and central India revived Vedic ritual and are linked to the carved railings of the Bharhut Stupa. Sea trade with Rome was the southern and Satavahana story, the Silk Route the Kushanas', and the Shaka era the Shakas'.
- 11. (B)** A Vedic-reviving dynasty still connected with carved railings on a Buddhist stupa shows the age's mixing of traditions; reviving one set of rituals did not stop art for another. It does not make the Shungas Buddhist, nor the stupa a Vedic temple, and Buddhism was clearly still alive.
- 12. (B)** A stupa is a dome-shaped Buddhist monument, frequently decorated with carved railings depicting religious stories. The poem anthology is Sangam literature, the river dam is an anicut, and the pillar describes something like the Heliodorus pillar.
- 13. (D)** The Shungas were a north-and-central-Indian dynasty. The Tamil south belonged to the Cholas, Cheras and Pandyas, the Deccan to the Satavahanas, and Central Asia to peoples like the Kushanas.
- 14. (D)** The Satavahanas were the great dynasty of the Deccan. The Tamil south had the three crowned kingdoms, north-central India the Shungas, and the northwest saw the Indo-Greeks, Shakas and Kushanas.
- 15. (C)** Ships stamped on Satavahana coins point to active maritime trade, which reached as far as Rome. The coins are read as evidence of commerce, not sea-worship, territorial

loss, or naval war with the inland Kushanas.

16. (D) 'Gautamiputra' means 'son of Gautami', a mother-name. The Satavahana custom of mother-names reflects the real influence of royal women. It is not a god's name, a city, or a monastic title.

17. (A) Gautami Balashri and other Satavahana royal women donated land and had inscriptions carved recording their gifts, which is how historians know of them. They were not army commanders against Rome, Tamil Sangam poets, or Gandhara sculptors.

18. (D) All three facts show royal women wielding real authority, directly contradicting the belief that queens were mere decoration. The other statements are accepted facts that this evidence does not challenge.

19. (C) Sea routes from the Deccan's western ports linked the Satavahanas to Roman markets. They did not border Rome, were never a Roman province, and the overland Silk Route was the Kushanas' domain, not theirs.

20. (D) Kharavela was the Chedi king of Kalinga. He was neither a Satavahana of the Deccan, a Kushana of Gandhara, nor a Chera of the Tamil south.

21. (C) Kharavela combined kingship with deep devotion to Jainism, hence 'monk-king'. He did not abdicate, was not a non-ruling Buddhist monk, and did not invent a new religion.

22. (C) The Hathigumpha inscription is carved writing recording a ruler's deeds, exactly the kind of inscription historians depend on. It is not Tamil poetry, a Roman record, or a coin portrait.

23. (D) An inscription is text cut into a lasting material such as stone or metal, frequently recording deeds, gifts or beliefs. A stamped coin, an oral poem and a wall painting are different kinds of evidence.

24. (C) The Tamil south's three crowned kingdoms were the Cholas, Cheras and Pandyas. The other sets belong to north/central-Indian dynasties, the northwestern invaders, and the great northern empires respectively.

25. (B) Sangam literature, the oldest Tamil poetry on love, heroism and generosity, gives the Sangam Age its name. It is named for a body of poetry, not for battles, a royal election, or a Buddhist council.

26. (A) Sangam literature expresses themes of love, heroism and generosity. It is Tamil court-and-life poetry, not a manual of Vedic ritual, a Kushana chronicle, or Silk-Route trade law.

- 27. (C)** Roman coins in the south reflect brisk sea trade between the Tamil kingdoms and Rome. They were never Roman subjects, did not mint in Rome, and their kings were crowned at home.
- 28. (C)** The Pandyas were a Tamil southern kingdom. The Cholas (also Tamil south) did not rule the Deccan (that was the Satavahanas), Kalinga was the Chedis' (not the Cheras'), and the northwest belonged to the invaders, not the Pandyas.
- 29. (D)** The Grand Anicut is an ancient dam across the Kaveri that diverted water across the delta, making it a rich rice region. It is not a stupa, a pillar, or a fort.
- 30. (A)** From Tamil anai ('dam') + kattu ('to build'), an anicut is a low dam that lifts river water into canals. It is not a marriage treaty (alliance), a monument (stupa), or a calendar (samvat).
- 31. (C)** By spreading the Kaveri's water across the delta, the Anicut created one of India's richest rice lands, feeding the population and armies behind Chola power. It was an irrigation work, not a naval barrier, a fortress, or a boundary marker.
- 32. (D)** The Cheras and Pandyas prospered on sea trade, reaching as far as Rome. The Silk Route was the Kushanas' overland network; they received no Kushana tribute and held no Central Asian mines.
- 33. (B)** Roman familiarity with Tamil-coast goods points to lively maritime commerce between south India and the Mediterranean: trade, not conquest, colonisation, or Tamil rule in Italy.
- 34. (B)** Both the Deccan Satavahanas and the southern Tamil kingdoms traded with Rome by SEA, using their coastal ports. Neither relied on the overland Silk Route, which connected China to the Mediterranean through the Kushana lands.
- 35. (A)** The Indo-Greeks descended from the Greek satraps Alexander left in the northwest. They were not Shungas, Chedis, or Kushanas.
- 36. (C)** A Greek envoy raising a pillar in devotion to an Indian deity shows cultural blending, with the Indo-Greeks absorbing Indian beliefs. It is the opposite of forcing Greek gods, shunning Indian religion, or destroying temples.
- 37. (C)** Much of our knowledge of the Indo-Greek kings comes from their coins, which preserve names and portraits. The coins were real trade currency, not Roman-minted, and carried no Tamil Sangam poetry.
- 38. (C)** The Mauryan collapse left the northwest poorly defended, opening the door to the Indo-Greeks. The southern Cholas did not invite them, the Kushana Silk Route came later, and the Shaka era is unrelated to their arrival.

- 39. (A)** Though they arrived as conquerors, the Indo-Greeks and Kushanas were deeply influenced by India's culture, producing blends in which Indian themes stayed dominant. They neither erased Indian culture, nor stayed wholly separate, nor unified all India.
- 40. (B)** The Shakas are called the Indo-Scythians. The Indo-Greeks were a different group of invaders; 'Indo-Romans' and 'Indo-Cholas' are not terms used in the chapter.
- 41. (A)** A calendar era, the Shaka Samvat, was developed in the Shaka period and India's national calendar still uses it. The Julian calendar is Roman, and the other two are not calendars at all.
- 42. (C)** From Sanskrit samvatsara ('year'), a samvat is a reckoned era counted from a fixed starting point. The dam is an anicut, the shrine a stupa, and the marriage a matrimonial alliance.
- 43. (B)** A living national calendar rooted in the Shaka era is proof the age left enduring legacies. It is evidence against the ideas that nothing survived, that Romans ran it, or that it was cut off from Indian tradition.
- 44. (B)** Kanishka is the great Kushana king. Kharavela was a Chedi, Pushyamitra a Shunga, and Gautamiputra a Satavahana.
- 45. (A)** The Kushanas commanded stretches of the Silk Route, the great overland trade network between China and the Mediterranean. The Anicut was Chola, the Bharhut railings Shunga, and the Sangam academies Tamil.
- 46. (D)** The Silk Route was an overland network through Central Asia and Persia linking China to the Mediterranean. It was not a single Deccan sea lane, a Chola delta road, or a poets' circuit.
- 47. (D)** Kanishka's coins record his titles and depict a range of gods he honoured, evidence of his power and the era's religious mixing. They do not show him rejecting religion, ruling the Tamil south, or shunning trade.
- 48. (A)** Kushana overland trade plus Satavahana and southern sea trade means India was linked to distant markets by both land and sea at once, not isolated, village-bound, or reliant on one route.
- 49. (A)** Gandhara art clothed Buddhist subjects in Greek and Roman forms, such as wavy hair and toga-like robes, a Greco-Buddhist fusion of the northwest. The red-sandstone description is the Mathura school; the others are not art schools at all.
- 50. (A)** The Mathura school was an indigenous style centred on Mathura, carving fuller, rounder figures in spotted red sandstone. The Greek robes belong to Gandhara, the love-and-heroism poems to Sangam literature, and the ships to Satavahana coins.

51. (C) Gandhara is the Greco-Buddhist, Hellenistic-influenced school of the northwest; Mathura is the home-grown Indian school in red sandstone. Neither is Tamil, neither is purely Greek, and both are sculpture, not poetry.

52. (C) A Buddhist figure rendered in Greek forms is textbook cultural confluence, traditions flowing together into something new. It is not destruction of a culture, nor influence-free, nor a Vedic revival.

53. (B) Cultural confluence is the flowing-together of cultures to make new shared styles, with a strong local character surviving, exactly what happened in Indian art and coinage of this age. It is neither replacement, nor strict separation, nor unchanging spread.

54. (D) The chapter ties the flourishing of Sanskrit literature, including the Mahabharata and Ramayana, to this age. The Sangam anthologies are Tamil, the Arthashastra belongs to the earlier Mauryan period, and Hathigumpha is an inscription, not literature.

55. (D) Indian themes staying central in blended coins and art shows India absorbing and reshaping foreign influences while keeping its identity, not expelling them, not being wholly Hellenised, and certainly not halting art.

56. (C) Greco-Buddhist Gandhara art, Kanishka's coins honouring many gods, and a surge in Sanskrit literature are the concrete proofs of confluence. There was no single imposed style, foreign elements were clearly present, and Indian religions thrived.

57. (D) Coins (ships, titles, gods) and inscriptions (Hathigumpha, Nashik, Naneghat) carry much of what we know, since continuous written chronicles are scarce, hence their value. It is not that no one was literate, that nothing was built, or that Rome wrote its history.

58. (A) Coins, cave inscriptions and sculptures are exactly the durable physical sources the chapter relies on. The other lists contain modern items that did not exist in this age.

59. (B) The Maurya breakup (c. 185 BCE) came first; the Satavahanas rose in the 2nd century BCE; Kanishka's Kushanas peaked in the 2nd century CE. So breakup, then Satavahanas, then Kanishka is the right order.

60. (B) The age shows division and creativity side by side: rival kingdoms warred and allied while Gandhara and Mathura art, far-reaching trade and Sanskrit literature flourished. The age was not unified, art and trade did not stop, and Indian culture was not banned.